

Project Design Phase

Problem – Solution Fit Template

Date	26 June 2026
Team ID	Solo
Project Name	ShopEZ – Ecommerce Application
Maximum Marks	2 Marks

Problem – Solution Fit Template:

The Problem-Solution Fit simply means that you have found a problem with your customer and that the solution you have realized for it actually solves the customer's problem. It helps entrepreneurs, marketers and corporate innovators identify behavioral patterns and recognize what would work and why

Purpose:

- ☐ Solve complex problems in a way that fits the state of your customers.
- ☐ Succeed faster and increase your solution adoption by tapping into existing mediums and channels of behavior.
- ☐ Sharpen your communication and marketing strategy with the right triggers and messaging.
- ☐ Increase touch-points with your company by finding the right problem-behavior fit and building trust by solving frequent annoyances, or urgent or costly problems.
- ☐ **Understand the existing situation in order to improve it for your target group.**

Template:

1 CUSTOMER SEGMENT(S) Small-to-medium retail merchants needing an easy online storefront, and value-conscious online shoppers who want a trustworthy, curated shopping experience with flexible payment options.	2 JOBS-TO-BE-DONE / PROBLEMS Merchants: launch a professional online store and manage inventory & orders without heavy cost/tech. Customers: browse, compare and buy products smoothly, track orders, and pay via Card/UPI/COD.	3 TRIGGERS A seller sees competitors selling online while their shop stays offline and loses customers. A shopper abandons a cluttered, slow app during checkout and looks for a simpler alternative.	4 EMOTIONS: BEFORE / AFTER Before: frustration and anxiety from lost sales and manual, error-prone order tracking. After: confidence and relief with a real-time dashboard, live KPIs and a reliable checkout flow.
5 AVAILABLE SOLUTIONS (AS) Shopify/WooCommerce: powerful but costly and technical for small sellers to set up and run. Amazon/Flipkart marketplaces: high commissions, no brand identity or direct customer data. Manual selling via WhatsApp/phone calls: unscaleable, error-prone, no analytics or tracking.	9 PROBLEM ROOT CAUSE No affordable, easy-to-use dedicated platform combines an elegant, boutique-style storefront with real-time seller analytics and inventory tools — so small merchants fall back on fragmented, manual processes (notebooks, WhatsApp) to run their shop, while shoppers get generic, impersonal buying experiences.		6 CUSTOMER CONSTRAINTS (CC) Limited budget for subscription fees or high commissions. Limited technical skill to build or maintain a website. Need mobile-friendly access and secure, multiple payment modes (Card, UPI, Cash on Delivery).
7 BEHAVIOUR (BE) Sellers track orders manually in notebooks/spreadsheets or via WhatsApp chats with customers. Shoppers browse multiple apps, compare price/reviews across platforms before purchasing.	10 YOUR SOLUTION ShopEZ — a full-stack MERN e-commerce application. Customers get a premium "boutique" shopping experience: live search & category filters, multi-tab product details, a live-syncing cart, and a 3-step checkout supporting Card, UPI and Cash on Delivery. Sellers get a dedicated dashboard: live KPI cards (Revenue, Total/Pending/Delivered Orders), full inventory CRUD, and order-status management (Pending → Processing → Shipped → Delivered → Cancelled). Secured with stateless JWT auth, deployed on Render (Node 20.15.0). <i>Problem-Solution Fit: ShopEZ solves merchants' need for an affordable, easy storefront + analytics, and shoppers' need for a trustworthy, premium buying experience — closing the gap left by boxes 5 & 6.</i>		8 CHANNELS OF BEHAVIOUR WhatsApp Business & Instagram/ Facebook shop pages. Third-party marketplaces (Amazon, Flipkart, Meesho). Offline retail counters and word-of-mouth referrals.

References:

1. <https://www.ideahackers.network/problem-solution-fit-canvas/>
2. <https://medium.com/@epicantus/problem-solution-fit-canvas-aa3dd59cb4fe>